Water Care

The funding call

Global Affairs Canada: Call for preliminary proposals "Partnerships for Her Voice, Her Choice" (March 2018)

About this document. The pages that follow are a **real, public Global Affairs Canada call for proposals**, printed from GAC's website on 21 March 2018 and included unchanged. It is the call under which the fictional Taps for Rights project was funded. Everything else in this pack (Water Care, Taps for Rights, Nimbara, Sundara, the proposal, agreement, report and workbooks) is synthetic and has been deliberately altered to include errors for testing.

What to use it for

- Extract the call's requirements: eligibility, project parameters (funding range, duration, cost share, construction rules, location) and the outcomes a project must contribute to.
- Check the preliminary proposal against them, and later check the contribution agreement and the Year 3 report for anything that drifted from what the call allowed.
- Note what the call does not say. Where a requirement is unclear, your tool should flag the question for a person rather than decide.

Good to know

- The call was framed under Canada's Feminist International Assistance Policy (2017). Treat that framing as the policy context of 2018.
- The original web page and its linked forms are no longer online. The call's questions-and-answers page is not included.
- For this exercise, treat Nimbara and Sundara as ODA-eligible countries.

Government of Canada Gouvernement du Canada

Partnerships for Her Voice, Her Choice

> ⚠ **Deadline for submitting a proposal for this call: 12:00 p.m. (noon) Eastern Daylight Time on May 1, 2018.**

This call for preliminary proposals “Partnerships for Her Voice, Her Choice” is part of the $650-million funding over 3 years announced by Minister Bibeau in support of sexual and reproductive health and rights (SRHR) as a means of advancing gender equality and empowerment of all women and girls in line with the Feminist International Assistance Policy. The call focuses on comprehensive sexual education; reproductive health services and investments in family planning and contraceptives; the prevention of and response to sexual and gender-based violence, including child, early and forced marriage, and female genital mutilation and cutting; and initiatives that support the right to choose safe and legal abortion, as well as access to post-abortion care, including in fragile and conflict-affected settings.

You must submit your preliminary proposal through the Partners@International portal before the deadline. We will not accept any late submissions. Please read the portal instructions carefully and plan to submit your application at least 3 days before the closing date to ensure that technical difficulties do not prevent you from submitting your proposal by **12:00 p.m. (noon) Eastern Daylight Time on May 1, 2018.**

The total amount of funding available under the Partnerships for Her Voice, Her Choice (Sexual and Reproductive Health and Rights) call for preliminary proposals is $40 million from fiscal years 2018/19 to 2023/24. We may fund any number of proposals, or none, up to the maximum funding available.

The submission of a preliminary proposal is the first stage of a two-stage application process. Funding cannot be provided on the basis of a preliminary proposal. Be sure to review the instructions in How to apply for funding through a call for preliminary proposals before beginning your application.

Objective

Under this call, your project proposal **must** contribute to improved comprehensive sexual and reproductive health and rights (SRHR), with a focus on women and adolescent girls. You must include advocacy activities as either cross-cutting initiatives within a broader SRHR project, or through advocacy-specific outcomes.

Your project proposal **must** contribute to at least two of the following intermediate outcomes:

- Increased utilization of gender-responsive and adolescent-friendly comprehensive sexuality education and sexual and reproductive health services;
- Improved provision of gender-responsive and adolescent-friendly comprehensive sexuality education and sexual and reproductive health services;
- Reduced sexual and gender-based violence including child, early and forced marriage and female genital mutilation and cutting;
- Increased government and civil society responsiveness to the SRHR of women and adolescent girls.

You may adjust the call's ultimate and intermediate outcome statements to ensure they are grounded in the reality of your project design, making them more specific in terms of the **who, what, and where** of your project. Refer to the Results-Based Management How-To Guide to ensure that your outcome statements respect Global Affairs Canada's definition for intermediate and ultimate outcomes.

Your project's theory of change should also support:

- increased knowledge of SRHR issues and services among women and adolescent girls, men and boys, and community members;
- improved availability of quality sexual and reproductive health services, including referral services for women and adolescent girls;
- increased capacity of facility and community health providers to deliver gender-responsive and adolescent-friendly sexuality education and sexual and reproductive health services (including family planning and contraception, safe abortion where legal and post-abortion care, HIV/AIDS/STDs and sexual and reproductive health training);
- increased capacity of government facilities and civil society organizations to use evidence-based, gender-responsive, and adolescent and youth-friendly planning and management to develop policies and regulations for sexual and reproductive health services; and
- increased ability of women, male and female youth, adolescent leaders and community members to participate in decision-making spaces and advocate for women's and adolescent SRHR.

Your theory of change must also show how your project will:

- advance gender equality and the empowerment of women and girls;
- use a strong human rights-based approach and contain governance and/or advocacy activities to lift existing barriers and reduce the occurrence of harmful practices (early forced marriage, female genital mutilation and cutting, gender inequity, etc.);

- strengthen the capacity of both rights-holders and duty-bearers, and demonstrate a thorough understanding of effective governance strategies; and
- address the needs of the most vulnerable, particularly women and girls, and ensure the inclusion of marginalized groups (including but not limited to: LGBTQ2, the disabled, cultural minorities and Indigenous peoples).

Canada's Feminist International Assistance Policy states that: "No less than 95 percent of Canada's bilateral international development assistance initiatives will target or integrate gender equality and the empowerment of women and girls." Priority will be given to proposals that meet the requirement of **targeting or fully integrating** gender equality and women's and girls' empowerment in their design.

Organization eligibility

Carefully review the following eligibility screening requirements that we will use on submitted application packages for this call. We will not comment on the eligibility of specific potential applicants. To be eligible, you must be able to respond "yes" to each requirement below **and**, where stipulated, provide supporting documentation:

- Your organization is legally incorporated in Canada and you can provide proof of legal status.
- You are submitting only one application under this call as the lead implementing organization (i.e., as sole signatory with Global Affairs Canada). You may also participate in other applications as a non-signatory partner on another lead applicant's proposal.
    - If your organization submits more than one application under this call as lead applicant, we will only consider the one with the earliest submission time stamp.
- You can demonstrate relevant experience in Official Development Assistance (ODA) - eligible countries by providing examples of two projects you have managed in section 3.1 of the preliminary proposal. Both project examples must also demonstrate experience in sexual and reproductive health and rights, or other health-related programming.

If you are unable to respond "yes" to any of the above requirements, your organization is not eligible to apply under this call.

Required project parameters

Carefully review the parameters of this call and judge whether your project idea will fit. We will not respond to questions about the eligibility of your project idea. You must evaluate if your project idea fits within these parameters. You must be able to answer "yes" to all of the following statements for your application to be considered for funding under this call:

- **Funding requested:** You are requesting Global Affairs Canada funding of at least $2 million and less than $20 million.
- **Project duration:** The proposed project lasts at least two years and no more than five years.

- **Cost share:** The applicant provides at least 10 percent of the total eligible direct project costs over the life of the project in cash and/or in kind.
- **Project location:** The proposed project takes place in one or more Official Development Assistance-eligible countries as listed in the Partners@International portal of Global Affairs Canada.
- **Non-profit project:** The proposed project would not generate a profit for the applicant or any partner organizations.
- **Locally-driven proposal:** The applicant proposes to work with its own local office(s) or a local partner(s) in the country(ies) where the project would take place and has included information about them in the Local Partners – Information form.
- **Language of application:** The application package documents are complete and presented in either English or French, or a combination of these two languages.
- **Refurbishment:** Please note that Global Affairs Canada will not consider projects that include new construction. However, the Department will consider some refurbishment of existing structures. Refurbishment means any improvement to an existing structure adding no more than twenty-five percent (25%) of the existing footprint. All refurbishment activities must contribute to the SRHR objectives of the project. Organizations are required to demonstrate previous experience if undertaking construction or refurbishment, in Section E of the preliminary proposal form.

If your proposed project does not conform to the above statements, it will not be assessed because it cannot be considered for funding under this call.

Additional Guidance

Preference will be given to projects that include activities that take place in sub-Saharan Africa and countries of the Ouagadougou Partnership. A minimum of 60 percent of initiatives funded will take place in sub-Saharan Africa and countries of the Ouagadougou Partnership.

As Global Affairs Canada is seeking to diversify its partnerships with Canadian organizations, preference will be given to meritorious proposals in which the lead implementer (i.e., sole signatory with Global Affairs Canada) is not among the 36 Partnership for Development Innovation Branch partners receiving funding through the Partnerships for Strengthening Maternal, Newborn and Child Health (PSMNCH) initiative. PSMNCH partners can be contributing partners (i.e., non-signatory partner) to new applicants under this call. “New applicant” is defined as any organization that is not currently receiving funding under the PSMNCH initiative.

Please note that preference may be given to projects that include public engagement activities to increase Canadians’, including Indigenous populations’, understanding of SRHR in international development. Initiatives may allocate up to 10 percent of total direct program costs for public engagement activities in Canada. The purpose of this optional component would be to encourage Canadians to develop a deeper understanding of sexual, reproductive health and rights within the development context.

Preference may also be given to proposals that demonstrate innovative approaches such as new business models, approaches, policy practices, partnerships, technologies, and behavioural insights and methods of delivery, or any solutions that address development problems more effectively than current approaches.

Available resources

There are a number of resources available online to help you develop your application package. We strongly encourage you to read all of the following tools and guidance before beginning your application process. Failure to meet the mandatory requirements, minimum standards and deadlines detailed therein will result in your application package not being considered for funding.

- How we assess your proposal
- Partnerships for Her Voice, Her Choice call for preliminary proposals questions and answers
- Funding guidance
- Questions and answers about applying for funding
- How to apply for funding through a call for preliminary proposals
- Partners@International Portal FAQ

How to submit your application package

To be considered in this call, you must submit your complete application package to Partners@International by **12:00 p.m. (noon) Eastern Daylight Time on May 1, 2018.**

Your application package must include all of the following documents:

- Partnerships for Her Voice, Her Choice preliminary proposal form (completed, with Validated label on first page);
- Signed financial statements (2) for the lead implementing organization dated within 30 months of submission of the application. These statements should be signed by a member of the board of directors or delegate, if possible. Audited statements are preferred;
- The Local Partners – Information Form; and,
- Letter of incorporation or proof of organization's legal status.

As explained in How to apply for funding through a call for preliminary proposals, submitting your preliminary proposal is just the first step in the application process. After we review your preliminary proposal, we may invite you to submit a full application package. Funding decisions will only be made on the basis of a full proposal.

As noted above, plan to submit your application at least 3 days before the closing date to ensure that technical difficulties do not prevent you from submitting your proposal by **12:00 p.m. (noon) Eastern Daylight Time on May 1, 2018.** We cannot guarantee that we will be able to provide you with technical support to use the portal if we receive a high volume of requests for assistance in the last 24 hours before **the deadline above**.

Questions on using the Partners@International portal

Please read and follow all the instructions for using the Partners@International portal. Do not open multiple windows within the portal as this may cause technical problems.

DO NOT TRY TO REGISTER OR SUBMIT AT THE LAST MINUTE.

It may take up to 10 business days to register your organization in the portal. If you encounter technical difficulties while registering or trying to submit a proposal, send an email to: partners-partenaires@international.gc.ca. Please note that: during the last two weeks before a call closes, the service standard for replying to your enquiry is three (3) business days. Technical support for the portal is only available from 9 a.m. to 4 p.m. EDT, Monday to Friday.

Accessing and using PDF forms

Use only Adobe Reader/Adobe Acrobat to work on the standardized PDFs to be submitted with your application package. If you use other software, the data you enter may not appear once submitted to the department, and the application will be considered ineligible.

If you are having difficulty downloading the preliminary proposal form, it is generally due to software issues on your computer. Please read and follow the help instructions. If you have all the correct software installed, download the form to your desktop and open it directly in Adobe Reader; otherwise, other software installed on your computer may try (and fail) to open the form using your default settings.

Questions about this particular call

For general information about how to apply for funding, please consult Questions and answers about applying for funding.

If you have questions specific to this call, please send them to Correspondence.PDI@international.gc.ca **by 12:00 p.m. (noon) Eastern Daylight Time on Wednesday, April 4, 2018**. We will not respond to questions received after this deadline or to questions on specific organizational circumstances or on specific project proposals. Please note that all answers to questions will be posted on the Partnerships for Her Voice, Her Choice questions and answers page to ensure that all potential applicants have access to the same information at the same time. We will not send answers directly to applicants.

Date Modified:

2018-03-16